



**OrgInsights**  
An OrgPath Initiative



**Orgpath**  
Building Innovative Pathways



**ORGINSIGHTS**

**ASSESSMENT TAKER GUIDE**

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# INTRODUCTION

Congratulations on completing the assessment with OrgInsights! This is the first step in understanding your strengths, hidden talent, and weaknesses. Now what? How do you interpret and leverage this information? How can you really use this information to get ahead of the competition?

The below section of the guide will help you leverage the information you have received to better develop your resume, interview as well as get the job!

## WHAT IS INCLUDED:

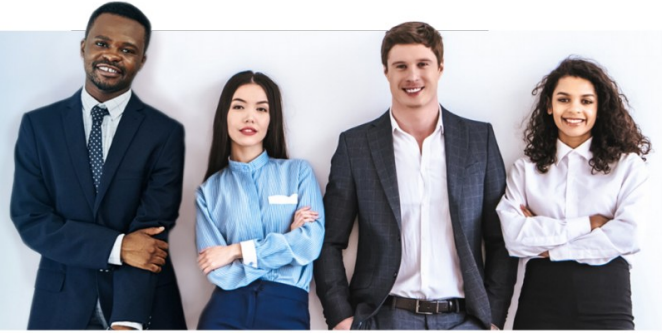
- Guide (this one) that will give you advice on how to leverage soft skills in your resume & interviewing.
- Guide on understanding & interpreting the results you received.
- Your OrgInsights Assessment and/or 360 Assessment (Depending on package selected)
- Your Industry & Development Report

Please use **this guide as a starting point**. It will give you all the information you need to ensure you can best leverage the information you have received. If you don't use this guide, you may not get as much value out of the data.



# OrgInsights Capabilities Model

Listed below are the capabilities that we measure. These traits are displayed in leaders who have met their full potential.



L

## LIMITS RISK

Maneuvers through complex situations and anticipates risks, while charting a path that avoids negative outcomes and achieves solutions with appropriate governance.

- **Scans for Politicals and Internal Impacts** Uses understanding of broad political, social and economic factors to maneuver through complex situations
- **Manages Risk** Forecasts and Evaluates risk and identifies processes to mitigate the negative impacts while attaining objectives
- **Reasons Critically and Solves Problems** Conducts root cause analysis to understand the problem and identify the practical and effective solutions
- **Establishes Governance** Works with stakeholders to ensure accountability, ethical behaviour, fairness and transparency

E

## EMBRACES AGILITY

Navigates changing situations and priorities. Thrives in change, anticipates and seizes opportunities, and adjusts behavior to empower teams.

- **Navigates Policies and People** Leverages a deep understanding of how organizations work to achieve objectives through tactful and savvy approaches
- **Thrives in Chaos** Maintains productivity in the face of change by adapting priorities and behavior
- **Leads and Embraces Change** Scans for opportunities to drive positive change and overcome barriers by remaining open to new ideas and approaches
- **Empowers Team Effectiveness** Creates resilient ecosystems by aligning and connecting team members through shared goals and resources

A

## ACHIEVES EXCELLENCE

Takes ownership and applies fiscal accountability and sound judgement in managing resources in order to achieve the best project possible outcomes.

- **Develops Talent** Actively supports self and team growth through investing in formal and informal development methods
- **Evolves With Technology** Embraces the use of new technologies to improve efficiency, spur transformational change and seize opportunities
- **Takes Ownership** Takes responsibility, faces criticism with courage, confronts problems and follows through on commitments
- **Drives Performance and Productivity** Navigates competing priorities, aligns objectives, and defines tasks and milestones to achieve organizational goals

D

## DEVELOPS RELATIONSHIPS

Builds strong relationships, creates safe spaces for diverse perspectives, and aligns the drivers of motivation with organisational priorities to promote productivity and build cohesion.

- **Creates Alliances** Establishes relationships with key partners and builds and maintains engagement
- **Demonstrates Empathy** Fosters collaboration by listening and withholding judgement to create safe spaces to share perspectives
- **Influences Responsibly** Uses compelling arguments and a deep understanding of stakeholder motivations to gain support responsibly and ethically
- **Focuses on Customers** Prioritizes client satisfaction by anticipating needs and listening without being defensive

S

## SETS PURPOSE

Aligns diverse perspectives and voices, creating a shared vision, which instills confidence and inspires others. Connects stories and datapoints. Communicates results and creates a clear call to action.

- **Inspires Others** Builds loyalty by clearly articulating a compelling vision the sincere intention of making a positive difference.
- **Communicates Clarity** Creates shared understanding and meaning by delivering concise and well articulated communications to diverse groups
- **Moves Data to Action** Uses market research and other analysis to build cohesive stories that connect the dots between data and calls to action
- **Embraces Diversity** Brings different perspectives to the table, confronts bias and addressing systemic barriers to inclusion and accessibility

# SCORING BENCHMARKS

Below you will see the expected benchmarks that should be achieved depending on the years of work experience and role a person has. As a client gain's more experience, they will be expected to score higher overall with CEOs and Presidents expected to scores high marks across all categories due to the nature of their roles and the breadth of their scope.

When reviewing the below "recommended scores" grid, there are several things to look at:

- **Years of Experience/Role** – Are they just starting out in their career or are they a Senior Leader? People entering their career will score lower generally and that's ok. As well, capability expectations are different
- **Industry** – Are they in Finance & Banking, an Engineering Firm, a Farm?
- **Size of Organization/Scope of Role** – People in the same role in different organizations may have different scopes and different requirements. This needs to be assessed through a discovery conversation.
- **Perspective/State of Mind** – Are they thinking with their current role in mind of future roles? Are they thinking as an Individual contributor when they should be putting on their manager hat? The viewpoint you answer from will impact your score

Depending on how long they have worked and the experience they have gained, as well as the position that they hold in your organization, there will be different expectations of capabilities required. When someone is first entering the market, there are lower expectations set and a handful of capabilities that are expected based on the industry they are interested in. As someone becomes more senior, the industry specific capabilities matter less and it's expected that they develop all the capabilities across the board at a competent level.



# RECOMMENDATIONS FOR ENHANCING YOUR RESUME

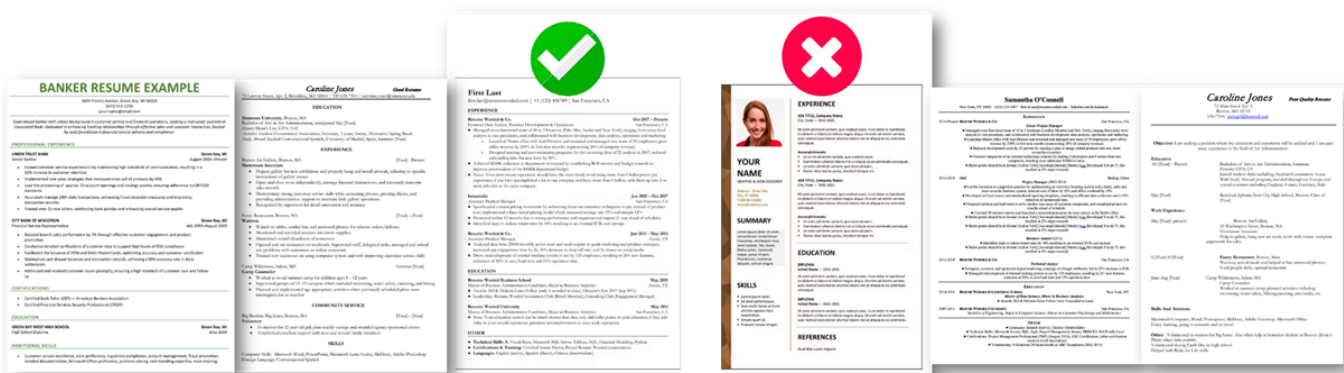


## Making Sure Your Resume Is Formatted Properly

Your resume is often the first impression a potential employer has of you, so it's critical to make it clear, concise, and professional. Recruiters spend an average of **6-10 seconds** scanning a resume before deciding whether to move forward, so **simple is better**. The best resumes follow tried-and-true formats that make it easy for recruiters and hiring managers to find key information quickly.

- **Font:** Use a clean, professional font like Arial, Calibri, or Times New Roman. Keep it consistent throughout the resume.
- **Font Size:** Use 10-12 point font for the body and 14-16 point for your name or section headers.
- **Sections:** Make sure you have clear headings (e.g., "Experience," "Education," "Skills") that stand out but are not overly stylized.
- **Margins:** Stick to standard margins (1 inch on all sides), though you can go slightly narrower (0.5-0.75 inch) if you need more space.
- **Bullet Points:** Use bullet points to break up text and make it easy to read.

This ensures that your resume can be quickly understood by both human recruiters and **Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS)**—the software many companies use to scan resumes before a human even sees them.



What your resume should look like

What your resume should **NOT** look like

## Showcase Your Soft Skills

Soft skills are *crucial* in today's job market, especially for new grads or early-career professionals. While technical skills are important, soft skills show how well you work with others, handle stress, and adapt to different situations. Employers *love* candidates who can demonstrate these qualities!

You can't just list "good communicator" on your resume and call it a day—no one believes it unless you show it! Here's how to highlight soft skills without sounding like you're bragging. Ensure that your responsibilities that you have for your role reflect the soft skills you have seen in the LEADS model and that have been flagged as your strengths and/or hidden talents.

**Example 1:** You may already be in a technology role where you build documentation, procedure documents and guides. What that really is doing, is **building governance documents and strategies**. Call it out with the right terminology and give your work the attention it deserves.

**Example 2:** If you are an analyst/data, most analysts focus on the technical skills you have developed during this time and your proficiency in Excel, SQL, and other data analysis related technologies. Instead of focusing on more technical skill sets, focusing on the soft skills you've learnt such as your ability to **reason critically and solve problems** or your ability to use the **data to build actionable plans**.



**Example 3:** Let's say you are an Assistant Manager in a Retail Company. You help ensure that loss prevention and theft policies are followed, you run store inventory audits, you draft policies to help decrease theft and ensure people are tracking things properly.

Although at first glance, it looks like you are just helping decrease theft, although this is the outcome what you are actually doing is building Governance strategies and limiting risk. You can write the same sentence in multiple ways but only one will reflect both your accomplishments and soft skills:

- **Basic approach:** Tracked inventory, executed audits and build policies to decrease theft in store.
- **More advanced approach:** Through the development of policies and audits and better inventory tracking we were able to decrease theft in store by 75% within 6 months.
- **Best:** Worked with staff to developed **Governance guidelines** and policies regarding inventory control to better **manage the risk** of lost inventory and decreased store theft by 75% within 6 months

The third approach shows that you have not only impacted the organization in a positive way, but gives an understanding of the skills you used to approach the issue and achieve success and the others just

## Use A “Skills” Section, But Be Smart About It

If you have a **Skills** section on your resume, list a few *key* soft skills, but always back them up elsewhere with examples. Avoid generic phrases like “hard worker” or “detail oriented.”

Instead, make it specific:

**Effective communicator**

**Creative problem-solver**

**Conflict resolution specialist**

| SKILLS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Customs and immigration    | Lifts more than 200 pounds |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Visa applications          | Critical thinking          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Document processing skills | Multitasking               |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Microsoft Office           | Decision making            |
| ADDITIONAL SKILLS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                            |                            |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ Proficient in Photoshop and Adobe Creative Suite</li><li>▪ Basic knowledge of HTML</li><li>▪ Basic knowledge of Adobe Dreamweaver</li><li>▪ Great photographer</li><li>▪ Keen eye for aesthetics with good understanding of image gradients</li><li>▪ Intermediate speaking level in Spanish</li></ul> |                            |                            |

## Skills Section and “North American Experience” Gap

If you are a new immigrant to the country, this is a great section to highlight your capabilities and let people know more about yourself. As well, it many times can be used to address the “No North American Experience” issue that people face when applying for roles. There are more details about this in the “**International Experience**” section

## Use A Professional Summary Instead of An Objective

Objective statements are becoming outdated. Instead, use a **Professional Summary** at the top of your resume to succinctly highlight who you are, what you’ve done, and what value you bring to the table.

**Example: Professional Summary:** Results-driven marketing graduate with a strong background in content creation, digital marketing, and social media management. Proven track record of increasing online engagement by 30% through targeted strategies. Eager to apply skills in a dynamic team environment.

This is a more compelling and specific way to introduce yourself than a vague objective like, “Seeking a role in a dynamic company where I can grow.”

## Bridging The Experience Gap: Leveraging Education and Projects on Your Resume

When lacking professional experience, you can effectively showcase your capabilities by highlighting your education and key projects on your resume. Start by positioning your education section prominently, including not just your degree but also honors like graduating on the Dean's List. Then, create a dedicated section for significant projects where you detail your role, the skills you utilized, and the outcomes achieved. By including such examples, you demonstrate your practical skills and readiness to contribute, helping to bridge the gap created by limited professional experience.

### Example 1

**Master of Arts in Political Science specializing in Canadian Politics and Minor in Research methods (Quantitative and Qualitative)**  
Wilfrid Laurier University, Waterloo

Graduated June 2009

### Example 2

**Master of Arts in Political Science specializing in Canadian Politics and Minor in Research methods (Quantitative and Qualitative)**  
Wilfrid Laurier University, Waterloo

Graduated June 2009

#### Key Projects:

##### **Analysis of the recognition of credentials for foreign trained doctors in Ontario (2006)**

- Conducted comprehensive research on the process that international medical graduates must navigate to have their credentials recognized in Ontario, examining how the lack of recognition negatively impacts the province. Analyzed the available methods for filing complaints and argued that the Ontario Ombudsman's office, due to its impartiality, could more effectively address the issue if empowered to do so. Recommended specific changes to improve the credential recognition process. **Final Grade: A**



## Address The “No Experience” Challenge:

Include Relevant Experience Beyond Paid Jobs. If you don’t have much work experience, don’t worry. Employers understand that new graduates may not have extensive professional backgrounds, but they still want to see relevant experience. Include internships, volunteer work, part-time jobs, free-lance work, or even significant class projects if they relate to the job.

### *Example:*

#### **Relevant Experience:**

##### **Marketing Intern**

ABC Company, Summer 2022

- Created and managed content for social media platforms, increasing engagement by 20%.
- Assisted with email marketing campaigns, resulting in a 15% open rate increase.

## Address The “No North American Experience” Challenge

As a new immigrant entering the North American job market, you might be concerned about not having local work experience. However, you can overcome this hurdle by highlighting your transferable skills—especially soft skills—and presenting your international experience effectively on your resume. Here’s how you can do it:

### **Highlight Your Transferable Soft Skills**

Soft skills are personal attributes that enable you to interact effectively with others. They are highly valued by employers in Canada and the United States.

**Communication Skills:** Emphasize your ability to communicate clearly in English (and other languages if applicable).

**Teamwork:** Showcase experiences where you’ve successfully worked in a team setting.

**Adaptability:** Highlight your ability to adjust to new environments and cultures.

**Problem-Solving:** Provide examples of how you’ve tackled challenges effectively.

**Leadership:** Mention any instances where you’ve led a project or team.

### *Example:*

#### **Skills**

**Effective Communication:** Fluent in English and Mandarin; excellent interpersonal skills.

**Team Collaboration:** Worked with diverse teams across international projects.

**Adaptability:** Quickly adapt to new technologies and work environments.

**Problem-Solving:** Proficient in analyzing issues and implementing solutions.

**Leadership:** Led a team of 5 in developing a marketing strategy.





## **Address The "No North American Experience" Challenge Cont..**

### **Include Volunteer Work and Community Involvement**

Participation in local activities shows your commitment to integrating into North American society.

#### ***Example:***

##### **Volunteer Experience**

**Volunteer Coordinator**, Local Food Bank | 2022 – Present

Organize weekly schedules for 30+ volunteers.

Develop community outreach programs to increase donations.

### **Obtain Relevant Certifications or Training**

Certifications recognized in North America can strengthen your resume.

#### ***Example:***

##### **Certifications**

**Certified Professional Accountant (CPA)** – Ontario, Canada | 2023

**Project Management Professional (PMP)** – Project Management Institute | 2022

### **Use a Professional Summary to Introduce Yourself**

A brief summary at the top of your resume can immediately highlight your strengths.

#### ***Example:***

##### **Professional Summary**

Experienced Project Manager with over 5 years of international experience in the construction industry. Proven ability to lead teams, manage budgets, and deliver projects on time. Highly adaptable with strong communication skills, seeking to contribute to a dynamic team in Canada.



### Frequently Overlooked Tips for Standing Out:

Below you will find other tips on ensuring that your application and resume stand out (in a good way). They are not frequently thought about, but they can impact your resume and application.

- **Use a Professional Email Address:** Create an email that includes your name (e.g., john.smith@gmail.com) and avoid informal or unprofessional addresses like "coolguy123@gmail.com."
- **Don't Overload It with Buzzwords:** While it's important to use the right keywords, avoid overloading your resume with corporate jargon or buzzwords that don't add real value. Employers prefer clear, direct language that demonstrates your skills and experience.
- **Include a LinkedIn Profile:** If you have a polished LinkedIn profile, add the link at the top of your resume. It shows you are proactive about your professional image.
- **Leverage a Personal Website or Portfolio:** If applicable to your field (e.g., graphic design, writing, coding), include a link to your personal website or portfolio where employers can see more of your work.
- **Include Certifications:** If you've earned any relevant certifications (e.g., Google Analytics, PMP, coding languages), include them in a "Certifications" section. These can set you apart from other candidates with similar experience.

## Things You Should NOT Do In Your Resume

On the other side, there are things that can very negatively impact your application status and cause your resume to be overlooked. In North America, there are best practices and general principles that are followed when applying for roles. The below are things that will negatively flag your resume/application. Don't fall victim to these issues!

- **Don't Include a Photo or Personal Details:** In North America, it's unnecessary and even frowned upon to include personal information like your photo, age, or marital status on your resume. Focus on professional details instead.
- **Don't List Irrelevant Work Experience:** While all experience is valuable, listing unrelated jobs can clutter your resume and take away from your relevant qualifications. Focus on experiences that apply to the role.
- **Don't Be Too Vague About Achievements:** Simply listing job duties without providing measurable results won't help you stand out. Quantify your achievements to show the value you brought to previous roles.
- **Don't Overload the Resume with Text:** Long paragraphs and dense text make it difficult for recruiters to quickly scan your resume. Use bullet points and concise language.
- **Don't focus on Duties, focus on Accomplishments:** Listing responsibilities without showing how you excelled doesn't help you stand out. Focus on what you achieved in each role.
- **Don't References Directly on the Resume:** Listing references takes up valuable space. It's enough to write 'References available upon request' or leave this out entirely.
- **Don't Leave out your Contact Information:** Ensure that your phone number, email address, and LinkedIn profile are easy to find. These are essential for employers to reach you.
- **Don't Include Salary Expectations or Visa Information:** Including this information can work against you. Discuss salary or visa status later in the process when it's requested.



# LEVELLING UP YOUR INTERVIEW GAME: BECOMING A STAR

## Pre-Interview Preparation: What Every Job Seeker And New Graduate Should Do Before The First Phone Screen Or Interview

Before you even get on a phone call or step into an interview room, proper preparation is key to ensuring you make a strong impression. Taking the time to prepare not only helps you feel more confident, but it also shows potential employers that you are serious about the opportunity.

### Research the Company Thoroughly

Before any interaction with the hiring team, it's critical to **research the company**. A lack of knowledge about the employer can hurt your chances, as it suggests you're uninterested or unprepared.

Here's what you need to focus on:

- **Company Overview:** Familiarize yourself with the company's mission, values, and culture. Check their website, social media channels, and any news articles to stay informed about recent developments.
- **Industry:** Understand the company's position in its industry and its competitors. You don't need to be an expert, but having general knowledge shows you're serious about the opportunity.
- **Key Players:** Look up the leadership team, especially anyone who might be interviewing you. Knowing who you'll be speaking with can give you an edge and help you tailor your questions or conversation.

### Study the Job Description in Detail

A well-prepared candidate knows the job description inside and out. **Break down the requirements** and make sure you understand what's expected of the role. Match your skills, experience, and achievements to the key qualifications they are looking for.

- **Identify your strengths:** Highlight areas where your skills perfectly align with the job description.
- **Prepare to address any gaps:** If you don't meet 100% of the qualifications, be ready to discuss how your other skills or your ability to learn quickly can bridge those gaps.

### Prepare Your Key Talking Points

You'll want to walk into the interview ready to discuss your background, but it's important to **focus on what's relevant to the position**. Here's how to prepare:

- **Craft your elevator pitch:** Prepare a concise summary of who you are, your professional background, and what you bring to the role.
- **Frame your experience:** Think about 3–5 accomplishments or projects that best demonstrate your abilities and tie them directly to the job you're applying for.



## Pre-Interview Preparation: What Every Job Seeker And New Graduate Should Do Before The First Phone Screen Or Interview Cont...

### Prepare Thoughtful Questions

Hiring managers are evaluating you, but you should also be evaluating the company. **Prepare questions** that not only demonstrate your interest in the role but also help you gauge whether the company is the right fit for you. Examples include:

“What are the key goals for someone in this role in the first 6–12 months?”

“Can you tell me about the company culture and team dynamics?”

“What does success look like in this position?”

Asking thoughtful questions can show your genuine interest in the role, while also giving you deeper insight into the position and the company.

### Test Your Technology for Virtual Interviews

If your interview is going to be virtual or over the phone, don't wait until the last minute to check your equipment. **Technical issues** can quickly derail a great conversation and leave a poor impression.

- **Test your internet connection:** Make sure it's stable and reliable.
- **Test your camera and microphone:** For video interviews, ensure the camera is positioned well, with good lighting, and that your microphone is clear.
- **Find a quiet space:** Minimize background noise, and ensure that your surroundings are professional and free from distractions.

### Review Your Resume and LinkedIn Profile

Make sure your resume is up-to-date and **consistent** with what's on your LinkedIn profile. Hiring managers often check both. Be prepared to talk through any gaps in employment, transitions between jobs, or specific projects you've highlighted. Also, make sure your LinkedIn profile is polished and reflects the same key points as your resume.

### Practice Mock Interviews

Whether it's with a friend, mentor, or even in front of a mirror, **mock interviews** help you polish your responses and get comfortable speaking about your experience. Focus on:

- **Clear, concise answers:** Don't ramble or go off-topic.
- **Body language:** Make sure to maintain eye contact, sit up straight, and use appropriate gestures.
- **Pacing and tone:** Avoid speaking too fast or too slowly. Practice maintaining an upbeat, confident tone.

### Know Your Availability and Salary Expectations

Be prepared to **discuss your availability** for the role, including your potential start date. If salary is likely to come up, have a **range** ready based on your research of the market and your level of experience. Sites like Glassdoor and PayScale can help you find industry-standard salaries for similar positions.

### Get a Good Night's Sleep

It might seem obvious, but getting enough sleep the night before is essential for being at your best. **A well-rested mind** will help you stay calm, focused, and responsive during your interview.

## Dress For Success - Interview Attire and Etiquette

When it comes to interviews, both in-person and virtual, the way you present yourself can make a lasting impression. Whether you're a seasoned professional or a fresh graduate, dressing and behaving appropriately plays a crucial role in shaping how employers perceive you.

### In-Person Interviews:

- **Understand the Company Culture:** Research the company's dress code beforehand. If it's a corporate or conservative environment, opt for formal attire (e.g., suits or professional dresses). For more relaxed workplaces, business casual is acceptable, but it's better to be slightly overdressed than underdressed.
- **Invest in Fit and Quality:** Your clothing should be clean, well-fitted, and wrinkle-free. Ill-fitting clothes can be distracting and suggest a lack of attention to detail. Polish your shoes and avoid flashy or excessive accessories.
- **Neutral and Professional Colors:** Stick to neutral colors like navy, black, gray, or white. These convey professionalism and are less likely to distract the interviewer from your qualifications and skills.
- **Grooming Matters:** Personal hygiene is paramount. Make sure your hair is neat, your nails are clean, and your breath is fresh. Avoid overpowering colognes or perfumes, as these can be distracting or bothersome in a small room.

### Online Interviews:

- **Professional from the Waist Up:** Even if you're behind a screen, dress as if you're meeting in person. At the very least, wear a button-up shirt, blouse, or blazer. Avoid the temptation to wear sweatpants or pajamas below the camera line—you never know when you'll need to stand up!
- **Choose a Simple Background:** Your interview setting should be distraction-free. A plain wall or a tidy space will keep the focus on you, not your surroundings. Ensure proper lighting, and sit facing a window or a light source for a clear, bright appearance.
- **Test Technology in Advance:** Dress rehearsal isn't just for actors—test your equipment (camera, mic, internet) before the interview to avoid any last-minute hiccups. It shows you're prepared and serious about the opportunity.



## How To Highlight Soft Skills in An Interview

The interview is *the* time to show off those soft skills in action. Here's how you can subtly weave them into your answers:

### Use the STAR Method to Show Problem-Solving & Teamwork

The STAR method (Situation, Task, Action, Result) is *perfect* for soft skills questions. It gives you a structure for storytelling that really highlights how you've used your skills in real life.

**Example Question:** "Tell me about a time you worked in a team."

**Answer using STAR:**

- **Situation:** "At my internship, we had to work on a project with a tight deadline."
- **Task:** "I was responsible for coordinating between the marketing and sales teams to ensure everyone was on the same page."
- **Action:** "I set up weekly meetings and clear communication channels to keep everyone aligned."
- Result:** "We finished the project ahead of schedule, and our cross-team collaboration increased by 25%."

This shows teamwork, communication, *and* time management—all in one story! Plus, it paints you as a capable team player with real results. ☑

### When They Ask About Strengths, Highlight Soft Skills

When the interviewer says, "Tell me about your strengths," it's your time to shine. Don't just say you're a "good communicator"—talk about **how** you communicate well.

**Example Answer:** "I think one of my biggest strengths is my ability to communicate with people from different backgrounds. For example, at my last job, I regularly had to explain technical information to non-technical team members, and I got really good at simplifying complex concepts so everyone understood."

This way, you're proving the strength instead of just saying it. ☑

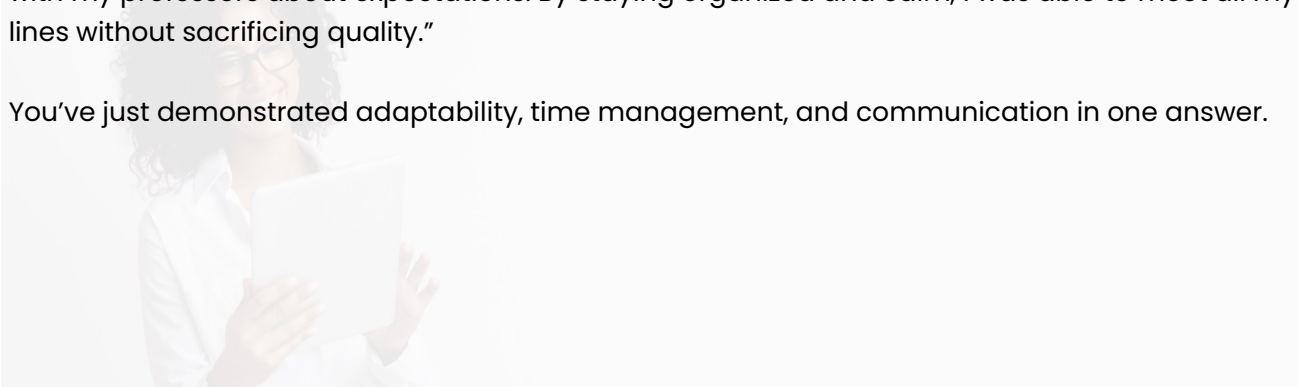
### Answer Behavioral Questions with Soft Skills in Mind

Behavioral questions are designed to find out *how* you'll handle situations at work. Always answer these with soft skills at the forefront.

**Example Behavioral Question:** "How do you handle stress or tight deadlines?"

**Answer:** "I prioritize tasks and focus on what's most urgent first. For example, during finals week at school, I had to juggle multiple assignments. I broke them down into smaller steps and communicated with my professors about expectations. By staying organized and calm, I was able to meet all my deadlines without sacrificing quality."

You've just demonstrated adaptability, time management, and communication in one answer.



## Tackling The Salary Question

One of the most challenging and nerve-racking moments in the job search process is when the conversation turns to salary expectations. Many job seekers, especially new graduates, feel uncertain about how to answer this question without underselling themselves or pricing themselves out of an opportunity. As your career coach, here's how you can confidently navigate this situation and ensure you are well-prepared.



### Do Your Research

The first step in tackling the salary question is knowing what's reasonable for the role, industry, and location you're applying to. Here's how you can conduct thorough research:

- **Online Resources:** Websites like Glassdoor, PayScale, LinkedIn Salary Insights, and Salary.com provide data on what companies are paying for specific roles.
- **Job Descriptions:** Some job postings will list the salary range. Pay attention to these because they reflect the company's expectations.
- **Industry Networks:** Reach out to people in your network or recent graduates working in your desired field.
- **Cost of Living Adjustments:** Keep in mind that salaries vary significantly depending on location due to cost of living. A salary in New York will likely be higher than in a smaller city, but the cost of living can impact how far that salary will stretch.

### Know Your Value

Your salary expectations should be grounded in your research but also reflect your unique skills, experience, and the value you bring to the company.

- **Entry-Level Candidates:** As a new graduate, you might feel you don't have enough experience to command a competitive salary. However, don't undersell yourself! Highlight internships, volunteer work, project experience, and relevant coursework that demonstrate your ability to add value from day one.
- **Experienced Professionals:** If you've already had some work experience, know how that translates into added value for your prospective employer. Did you lead projects? Drive measurable improvements? These are factors that should elevate your salary expectations.

## Tackling The Salary Question Cont..

### Handling the Salary Question

When the topic of salary comes up in an interview or application, it's essential to be prepared. Here are a few strategies to use:

- **Delay Until You Have More Information:** If the salary question comes up too early (before you fully understand the job responsibilities and company culture), it's okay to tactfully delay. You can say something like:  
*"I'd love to discuss salary, but I think it's important to get a clearer understanding of the role and responsibilities first so that I can give you a well-informed figure."*
- **Provide a Range:** After doing your research, provide a salary range rather than a single figure. This allows for flexibility while also demonstrating that you've done your homework. For example:  
*"Based on my research and understanding of the role, I'm looking for a salary in the range of \$X to \$Y. I'm open to discussing further based on the overall compensation package and growth opportunities."*
- **Reverse the Question:** Sometimes you can shift the conversation back to the employer to get a better idea of what they're willing to offer. You might say:  
*"I'm flexible and more focused on finding the right opportunity and team. What range do you typically offer for someone in this role?"*

### Prepare for Negotiation

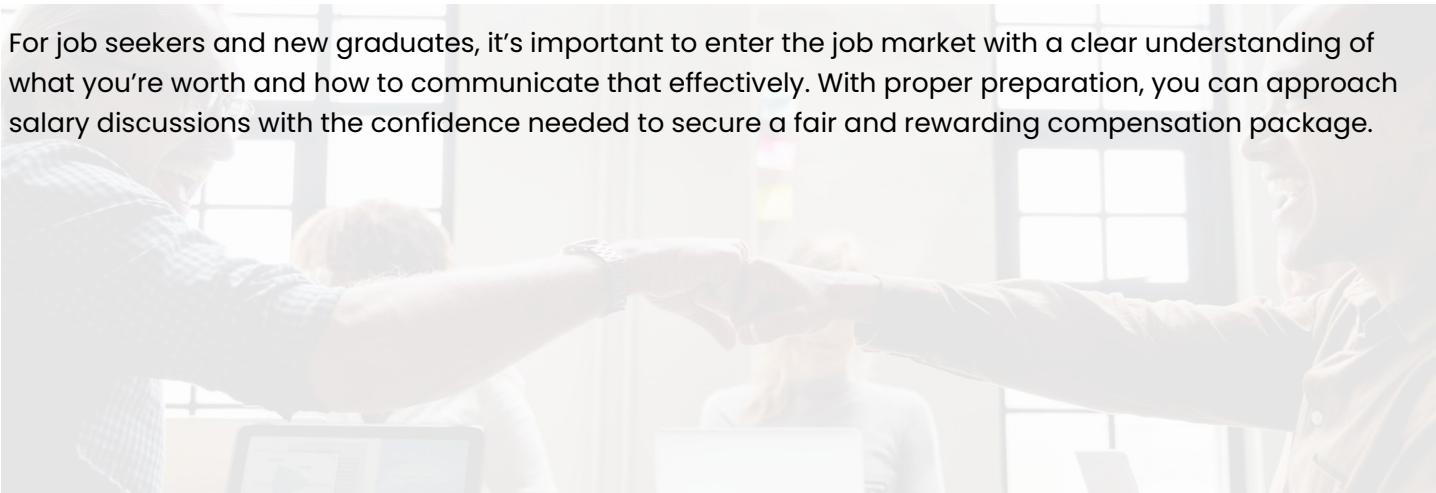
It's crucial to prepare for negotiation, as the initial salary offer may not always be what you're expecting. Keep in mind:

- **Know Your Bottom Line:** Before going into the interview, decide on a minimum salary you're willing to accept. This will help you stay grounded in negotiations.
- **Consider the Entire Compensation Package:** Salary is just one part of the equation. Take into account benefits like health insurance, retirement contributions, bonuses, stock options, vacation time, and work-from-home flexibility. Sometimes these perks make up for a lower salary.
- **Stay Professional:** Even if the offer is below what you expected, stay positive and professional. Show appreciation for the offer, and then present a well-reasoned counter based on your research and the value you bring to the company.

### Be Confident and Open

Ultimately, the salary question is a negotiation. Confidence in your research and your value will show the employer that you take your career seriously and are prepared to discuss it professionally. Remember, employers expect salary discussions—it's a normal part of the hiring process, so don't shy away from it.

For job seekers and new graduates, it's important to enter the job market with a clear understanding of what you're worth and how to communicate that effectively. With proper preparation, you can approach salary discussions with the confidence needed to secure a fair and rewarding compensation package.





## Common Pitfalls for Younger Job Seekers: How to Avoid Missteps In The Interview

It's crucial to discuss some of the common challenges and traps that younger job seekers are facing today. While you may have the technical skills and qualifications, certain behaviors, unrealistic expectations, and lack of preparation can seriously hinder your chances of landing a job. Here are some key issues to be aware of, along with strategies to overcome them, so you can put your best foot forward in the job search process.

### Bringing Parents to Interviews

While family support is important, bringing a parent to an interview, either physically or via virtual meetings, is a huge red flag for employers. It suggests a lack of independence and professionalism.

- **Why It's a Problem:** Employers are looking for candidates who are self-sufficient and able to handle their responsibilities. Having a parent in an interview signals that you might not be able to make decisions on your own or manage professional interactions independently.
- **How to Overcome It:** Leave parents out of the interview process. Prepare thoroughly on your own, and if you need advice or feedback, seek it from a mentor, career coach, or peer before the interview. Confidence comes from being prepared and showing the hiring manager that you are ready to step into a professional role without relying on others to advocate for you.

### Unrealistic Expectations About Salary and Job Roles

Many new graduates enter the job market expecting high salaries, immediate promotions, or prestigious job titles right out of the gate. While it's great to be ambitious, setting unrealistic expectations can set you up for disappointment or make you appear out of touch during interviews.

- **Why It's a Problem:** Companies value candidates who understand their industry, the economic environment, and the typical progression of a career. If you come across as entitled or unaware of the standard growth paths in your field, it can hurt your credibility.
- **How to Overcome It:** Do your research on typical entry-level salaries and job roles in your industry before the interview. Understand that the first few years are about gaining experience, learning, and proving your worth. Be flexible, and don't let unrealistic expectations keep you from great opportunities. Having a long-term vision and understanding the steps to get there will impress employers far more than over-ambition in the short term.

## Common Pitfalls for Younger Job Seekers: How to Avoid Missteps In The Interview Process Cont..

### Lack of Soft Skills

While technical skills are essential, many younger job seekers underestimate the importance of soft skills—communication, teamwork, problem-solving, and emotional intelligence. These are just as crucial for success in any workplace.

- **Why It's a Problem:** Employers consistently report that younger generations struggle with soft skills, which are vital for collaborating with colleagues, managing tasks, and interacting with clients. If you're overly focused on your technical skills but fail to show that you can work well with others or handle feedback, it could limit your opportunities.
- **How to Overcome It:** Make a conscious effort to develop and demonstrate your soft skills. During interviews, provide examples of situations where you've successfully worked in a team, communicated effectively, or resolved a conflict. Highlight internships, volunteer work, or group projects where you've shown initiative, leadership, and collaboration. Practice active listening, and show that you're open to learning from feedback.

### Over-reliance on Technology

Gen Z has grown up with technology and digital communication, but sometimes this reliance can be detrimental in professional settings. Over-reliance on text or email for communication, lack of face-to-face interaction skills, or even the habit of checking phones during interviews can be seen as a lack of professionalism.

- **Why It's a Problem:** Many jobs still require strong in-person communication skills, and constant use of technology during meetings or interviews can come across as disrespectful or unengaged. Hiring managers are also concerned that younger workers might lack the ability to build personal connections in the workplace.
- **How to Overcome It:** Practice in-person or virtual interview etiquette by maintaining eye contact, being present in the moment, and actively engaging in the conversation. Show that you can balance your digital proficiency with effective human interaction. During the interview, put away your phone and focus entirely on the interviewer.

### Over-Sharing Personal Information

While being personable is essential, it's important to strike a balance between professionalism and over-sharing. Some younger candidates might share too much personal information, such as weekend plans, family details, or even venting frustrations about their job search during interviews.

- **Why It's a Problem:** Oversharing personal information can make you appear unprofessional and distract from the conversation's focus—your qualifications for the job. Employers want candidates who can maintain appropriate boundaries in a professional setting.
- **How to Overcome It:** Keep the conversation focused on your qualifications, experience, and how you can contribute to the company. Avoid discussing overly personal matters unless it's directly relevant to the job or company culture. Maintain a professional tone throughout the interview.

## What Not to Do During An Interview:

While dressing appropriately is important, there are several common (and sometimes shocking) behaviors that can ruin your chances of landing the job. Here are things to **never** do in an interview:

- **Don't Chew Gum:** While it might freshen your breath, chewing gum during an interview is distracting and can come across as disrespectful.
- **No Cell Phone Distractions:** Your phone should be on silent or turned off entirely. Do not answer calls or texts during the interview and avoid fidgeting with it—even if you're in a virtual setting.
- **Do Not Wear Casual or Inappropriate Clothing:** Showing up in jeans, t-shirts, flip-flops, or overly revealing outfits sends the wrong message. It suggests a lack of respect for the opportunity and the interviewer.
- **Avoid Over-Perfuming:** While it's nice to smell pleasant, strong perfumes or colognes can overwhelm the room or even trigger allergies. Keep it minimal or skip fragrance altogether.
- **Do Not Lie or Exaggerate:** Honesty is key. If you don't know something, admit it and emphasize your willingness to learn. Getting caught in a lie can damage your reputation and trust with the employer.
- **Do Not Interrupt:** Let the interviewer finish their questions or statements before responding. Interrupting can seem aggressive or disrespectful, even if you think you know what they're going to ask.
- **Don't Use Slang or Inappropriate Language:** Stay professional at all times. Casual or overly familiar language can make you appear unprepared for a formal work environment.
- **Don't Show Up Unprepared:** Never walk into an interview without knowledge of the company, the role, or the industry. Employers expect you to have done your homework and to be ready with relevant questions or insights.



# OTHER TIPS TO HELP YOU LEAPFROG AHEAD OF THE COMPETITION

## Getting Comfortable with Talking About Soft Skills

A lot of people don't feel comfortable bragging about themselves, and that's okay! But the key is to focus on **facts** and **outcomes**, not just saying you're great. Here's how you can do it:

- **Practice with friends:** Get comfortable telling stories about your accomplishments that highlight your soft skills.
- **Have examples ready:** Before the interview, jot down a few experiences that showcase your strengths. This makes it easier to pull them up in the moment.
- **Get feedback:** Ask people in your network how they see your soft skills in action. Sometimes it's hard to recognize your own strengths!

Soft skills might not be the first thing that comes to mind when thinking about landing a job, but they're *huge*. Employers want to know not just **what** you can do but **how** you do it. By updating your resume and practicing these tips for interviews, you'll show them that you're not just another candidate—you're the *right* candidate.

## Networking: How To Build Connections and Get Ahead In Your Career

Networking is one of the most powerful tools in your job search. While it may seem daunting, especially for new graduates, networking is key to getting noticed, securing referrals, and accessing opportunities that may not even be advertised. The truth is, many jobs are filled through personal connections before they're ever posted online.

Here's how to **network effectively**, even if you don't know anyone in the company or industry, and how to turn those connections into job opportunities.

**Start with Who You Know:** Before trying to make new connections, look at the network you already have. You might be surprised by how many people in your existing circle can help you get started.

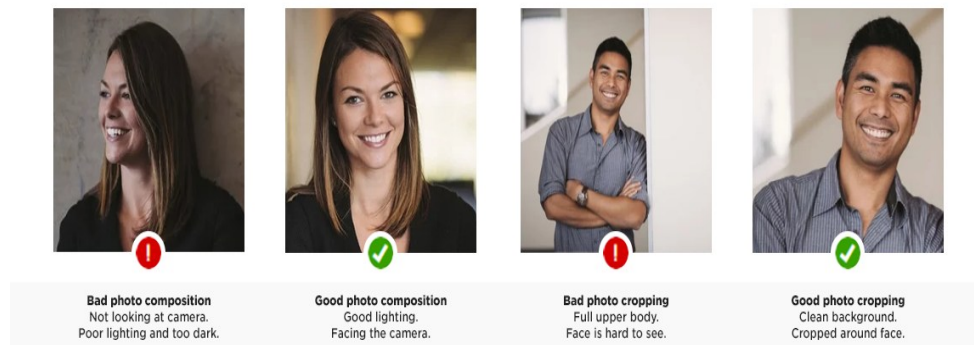
- **Family and Friends:** Don't hesitate to mention your job search to friends, family, or acquaintances. They may know someone in your field or be able to introduce you to someone who does.
- **Professors and Classmates:** Your professors have professional networks, and they can connect you with alumni or colleagues in your industry. Fellow graduates and classmates can also be valuable contacts, especially in the early stages of your career.

## Networking: How To Build Connections and Get Ahead In Your Career Cont...

### Create and Optimize Your LinkedIn Profile

LinkedIn is a crucial platform for professional networking. It's where recruiters go to find candidates and where you can make valuable connections.

- **Professional Profile Picture:** Use a high-quality, professional-looking photo. This helps people remember you and makes a great first impression.



- **Craft a Strong Headline and Summary:** Your headline should be clear and include keywords relevant to your field. In your summary, highlight your skills, experiences, and what you're looking for.

**Example Headline:** Marketing Graduate | Social Media Strategist | Content Creator

**Example Summary:** Recent marketing graduate with a passion for developing impactful content strategies. Skilled in social media management, SEO, and analytics. Excited to bring fresh ideas to dynamic teams and grow my career in digital marketing.

- **Grow Your Network:** Start by connecting with classmates, former coworkers, and professors. Then, reach out to people in your field, recruiters, and hiring managers.

### Attend Industry Events and Meetups

Industry events, whether in-person or virtual, are great opportunities to meet people in your field and make connections.

- **Conferences and Webinars:** These are often hosted by professional associations and organizations. They give you the chance to learn, ask questions, and connect with speakers and attendees.
- **Job Fairs and Career Expos:** Many universities and cities hold career fairs where you can meet recruiters and industry professionals. Prepare your elevator pitch, dress professionally, and have copies of your resume ready.
- **Local Meetups:** Attend industry meetups in your area. Whether it's tech, marketing, or finance, there's likely a group near you that holds networking events.

## Networking: How To Build Connections and Get Ahead In Your Career Cont...

### Reach Out to People in Your Desired Company or Industry

Even if you don't know anyone personally at the company where you want to work, you can still network your way in.

- **Find People in Similar Roles:** Use LinkedIn to find people who work in the role or department you're interested in. You can send a polite, professional message asking for advice or an informational interview. Here's an **example:**

*Hi [Name],*

*I'm a recent [degree/industry] graduate interested in [field/job title] and noticed you've had a lot of success in this area. I'd love to connect and hear more about your career path and any advice you might have for someone starting out. Thanks for your time!*

- **Request Informational Interviews:** An informational interview is not about asking for a job; it's about learning from someone in the field. Ask questions about their role, company, and industry trends, and seek their advice for someone in your position. Sometimes, these conversations can lead to job referrals or further introductions.

### Follow Up and Build Relationships

Networking is about **building genuine relationships** over time, not just making one-off connections. After you've met someone, whether through LinkedIn, an event, or an informational interview, make sure you follow up.

- **Send a Thank-You Note:** After an informational interview or networking conversation, send a brief thank-you message. Mention something specific you learned from them, and express appreciation for their time.

#### **Example:**

*Hi [Name],*

*Thank you for taking the time to speak with me today! I really appreciated your insights about [specific topic] and the advice on [specific advice]. Looking forward to staying in touch and following your work at [company].*

- **Stay in Touch:** Networking is an ongoing process. Share industry news, congratulate them on career milestones, or check in from time to time. This keeps the relationship alive and positions you as a thoughtful, engaged contact.

## Networking: How To Build Connections and Get Ahead In Your Career Cont....

### Leverage Networking to Get Referrals

Referrals are a powerful way to get your foot in the door at a company, and they can often fast-track your application to the top of the pile.

- **Ask for a Referral Thoughtfully:** Once you've built a rapport with someone at a company, it's okay to politely ask if they'd be willing to refer you for an open position. Be specific about the role you're interested in and why you think you're a good fit.

#### *Example:*

*Hi [Name],  
I hope you're doing well! I came across an opening at [Company] for a [position] and thought it aligns perfectly with my experience in [specific skill]. If you're comfortable, I'd be grateful if you could refer me for the role, as I've heard great things about working with your team. Thanks again for your time and consideration!*

- **Utilize Employee Referral Programs:** Many companies have formal employee referral programs that reward current employees for bringing in successful hires. If you have a connection at the company, they may be motivated to refer you.

### Join Professional Associations and Online Groups

Being a member of professional associations not only adds credibility to your resume but also gives you access to **valuable networking opportunities**.

- **Join Industry-Specific Associations:** Many fields have professional organizations that host events, webinars, and networking groups for members.
- **Participate in Online Communities:** Platforms like LinkedIn, Reddit, and industry-specific forums often have communities where you can engage in discussions, share insights, and connect with like-minded professionals.

#### *Example Groups:*

- LinkedIn groups for marketing, engineering, or finance professionals
- Reddit threads for career advice in specific industries

### Be Consistent and Patient

Networking isn't about instant results. It's a process of building relationships and maintaining a presence in your industry. **Consistency is key**

- **Follow up on opportunities:** When someone gives you advice or offers to connect you with someone, follow through promptly and professionally.
- **Be Genuine:** Networking is about building real relationships, not just trying to use people for job leads. Approach it with curiosity and a willingness to learn from others.
- **Give Before You Get:** Offer to help others in your network when you can—whether it's sharing resources, introducing people, or offering advice. Networking is a two-way street.
- **Keep Growing Your Network:** Even after you land a job, continue to network and build connections. It's not just about finding your next opportunity—it's about advancing your career over time.



## Enhancing Your Social Media Score and Maintaining A Controversy-Free Profile

In today's digital age, your social media presence plays a significant role in personal branding, career opportunities, and social interactions. A high social media score can open doors, while controversial content can close them. This guide will help you improve your social media score and ensure your profiles remain free of controversial content across all platforms.

### Understanding Social Media Scores

Social media scores are metrics that quantify your online influence and engagement. Platforms and third-party services analyze factors like follower count, engagement rates, content quality, and interaction frequency to assign a score. A higher score often translates to better visibility, credibility, and opportunities for collaboration or monetization.

### Improving Your Social Media Score

Enhancing your social media score involves strategic planning and consistent effort. Below are actionable steps to elevate your online presence.

#### 1. Complete and Optimize Your Profiles

- **Profile Picture and Cover Photo:** Use clear, high-resolution images that represent you or your brand effectively.
- **Bio and About Sections:** Write concise and informative descriptions including relevant keywords and hashtags.
- **Contact Information:** Provide up-to-date contact details to facilitate communication and networking.
- **Links:** Add links to your website, other social media profiles, or portfolios to create a network of your online presence.

#### 2. Engage Regularly with Your Audience

- **Respond to Comments and Messages:** Show appreciation and build relationships by replying promptly.
- **Interact with Other Posts:** Like, share, and comment on content from your followers and those you follow.
- **Participate in Discussions:** Join groups, forums, or trending conversations relevant to your niche.

## Enhancing Your Social Media Score and Maintaining A Controversy-Free Profile Cont...

### 3. Post High-Quality and Relevant Content

- **Visual Appeal:** Use high-quality images, videos, and graphics to capture attention.
- **Value Addition:** Share content that educates, entertains, or solves problems for your audience.
- **Consistency:** Establish a regular posting schedule to keep your audience engaged and anticipate your content.

### 4. Utilize Relevant Hashtags and Keywords

- **Research Trending Hashtags:** Use tools like Hashtagify or social media platform insights to find popular hashtags.
- **Create Branded Hashtags:** Develop unique hashtags to promote your brand or campaigns.
- **Keyword Optimization:** Incorporate relevant keywords in your posts to improve discoverability.

### 5. Connect with Influencers and Communities

- **Collaborate with Influencers:** Partner with individuals who have a strong following in your niche.
- **Join Communities and Groups:** Engage with like-minded individuals to expand your network.
- **Guest Posting and Features:** Contribute to blogs, podcasts, or social media takeovers to reach a broader audience.

### 6. Monitor Analytics and Adapt Strategies

- **Use Platform Analytics:** Regularly check insights provided by social media platforms to understand your performance.
- **Track Engagement Metrics:** Focus on likes, shares, comments, and follower growth.
- **Adjust Content Strategies:** Adapt your content based on what performs best with your audience.



## Enhancing Your Social Media Score and Maintaining A Controversy-Free Profile Cont...

### Ensuring a Controversy-Free Profile

Maintaining a clean profile is crucial for personal reputation and professional opportunities. Here are steps to ensure your social media remains free of controversial content.

#### 1. Audit Your Past Posts

**Review Old Content:** Go through your history to identify and remove any inappropriate or outdated posts.

**Delete or Archive:** Remove content that doesn't align with your current values or could be misconstrued.

**Check Tagged Photos and Posts:** Un-tag yourself from posts that could be deemed controversial.

#### 2. Adjust Privacy Settings

**Customize Audience Settings:** Control who can see your posts, photos, and personal information.

**Limit Past Posts Visibility:** Use platform settings to restrict the audience for older content.

**Manage Tagging Permissions:** Require approval before others can tag you in posts or photos.

#### 3. Be Mindful of Content Before Posting

**Think Before You Post:** Consider the potential impact and audience reception of your content.

**Avoid Sharing Unverified Information:** Ensure that any facts or news you share are accurate and from credible sources.

**Respect Intellectual Property:** Give credit where it's due and avoid sharing copyrighted material without permission.

#### 4. Avoid Sensitive Topics

**Stay Neutral on Controversial Issues:** Refrain from posting about politics, religion, or other divisive topics unless it's integral to your brand.

**Use Caution with Humor:** Avoid jokes or memes that could be offensive or misinterpreted.

**Cultural Sensitivity:** Be respectful of different cultures, traditions, and perspectives.

#### 5. Understand Platform Policies

**Read Community Guidelines:** Familiarize yourself with the rules of each platform to avoid violations.

**Stay Updated on Policy Changes:** Platforms may update their policies; stay informed to remain compliant.

**Report Violations:** If you encounter inappropriate content, use reporting tools to maintain a healthy online environment.

#### 6. Use Content Monitoring Tools

**Set Up Alerts:** Use tools like Google Alerts to monitor mentions of your name or brand.

**Employ Social Listening Tools:** Tools like Hootsuite or Mention can help track discussions and sentiments about you.

**Professional Services:** Consider hiring services that specialize in online reputation management.

By optimizing your profiles, engaging authentically with your audience, and carefully curating your content, you can enhance your online presence and open doors to new opportunities. Remember, your social media profiles are an extension of yourself—make sure they reflect the image you want the world to see.

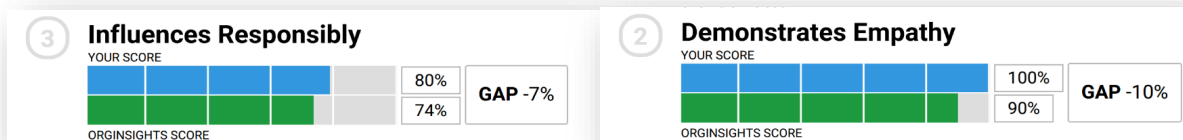
# ANALYZING THE REPORT: SCENARIOS AND HOW TO INTERPRET THEM

The next section will go over some scenarios that you might observe when reviewing the assessment for/with your client. This section is constantly being updated. If you find a scenario that has not been addressed, please reach out @ [akeel.mohamed@orgpath.io](mailto:akeel.mohamed@orgpath.io) and we will work to add additional details to the guide.

## UNDERSTANDING THE GAP BETWEEN THE SELF-ASSESSMENT AND ORGINSIGHTS ASSESSMENT

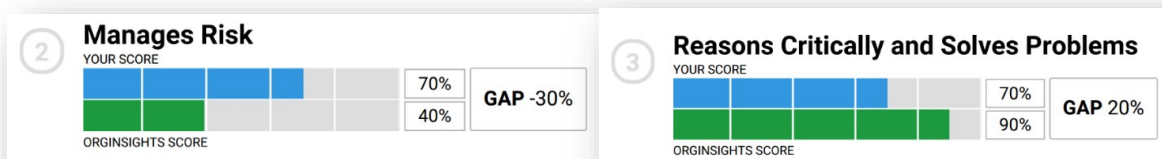
When reviewing questions and the gap between the Self-Assessment and the OrgInsights assessment, anything within the range of 20% to -20% is generally acceptable. Many times, the difference between a person scoring themselves “always” and “most of the time” can result in a change of up to 20%.

In the below **example 1**, you will see the gap is -10% and -7% and their scores in both areas are generally high. This would not be something that would be flagged as an area of concern. You may want to review, but it’s not worth investing too much time.



Example 1

In **example 2**, you will see the gap is more than -20%. Whether plus or minus, at those levels this is something you should start looking into. Is this an area of weakness? Do you know about this strength? Is there any value in paying more attention? Many times, when the gap grows larger than +/- 20% that indicates a blind spot or hidden talent.

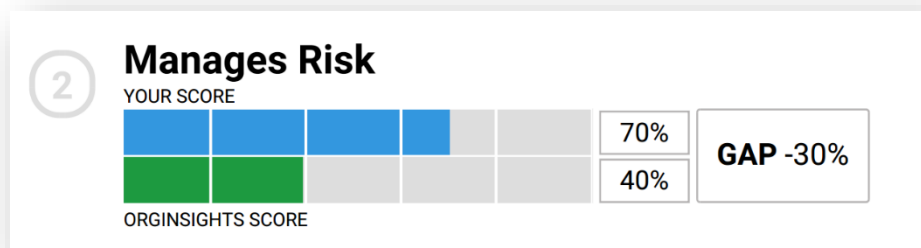


Example 2

## ORIGINLIGHTS SCORE DOES NOT ALIGN WITH THE SELF-ASSESSMENT SCORE

Do the scores from the OrgInsights Assessment not align with the Self-assessment? Depending on the taker, this may happen a lot. What this means is: The assessment taker is very confident about their abilities when they self-assessed but when they are faced with a situation, their approach/preference doesn't align with their self-assessment. They react very differently in a real-life scenario than they believe they do.

Below you will see an example (3) of this:



Example 3

Find out why in a scenario, you scored lower. Is this because you mis-interpreted the question? Perhaps you don't understand the importance of the capability at your level? Maybe it's a weakness you need to focus on? The key is to identify why and understand if there is development required in the capability.

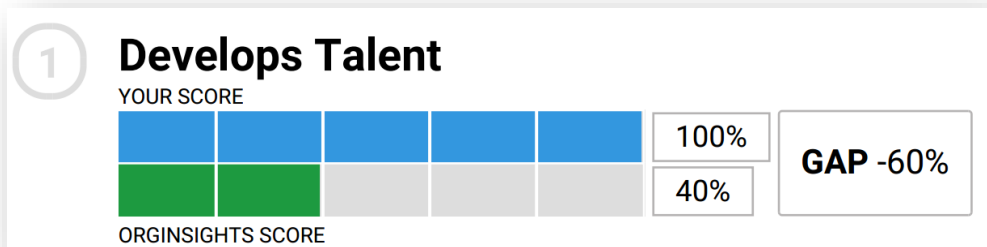
## LINK BETWEEN QUESTIONS & CAPABILITY BEING TESTED ISN'T CLEAR

When reviewing the questions, sometimes you might come back and think the question is not relevant or that it doesn't represent their level. A few things to think about:

- The benchmarks were built through the collection of several hundred assessments and in collaboration with multiple experts. As well, we review and update our benchmarks on an annual basis.
- There has been thought put into all the questions to drive specific outcomes. Although it might not make direct sense, there is logic. Not seeing the co-relation, does not mean it's not true.
- Behavioural Scientists that are certified by the APS drafted all questions. In addition, Mapien has been in the People Consultancy and Talent Psychometrics space for over 50 years and is one of the largest People Consultancies in Australia and the Asia-Pacific region.
- If you are really not sure, reach out to the OrgInsights team @ [akeel.mohamed@orginsights.io](mailto:akeel.mohamed@orginsights.io) and we would be more than happy to provide you additional information and context.

GETTING EXPECTED ORGINSIGHTS SCORE BUT LARGE GAPS BETWEEN SELF-ASSESSMENT SCORES

Another scenario that happens occasionally (**example 4**) at lower levels (Manager and below generally) is that you may score what is expected for your level in the OrgInsights assessment but scored yourself very high in the self-assessment. This many times is indicative of a person that believes their capabilities may be stronger than they think.



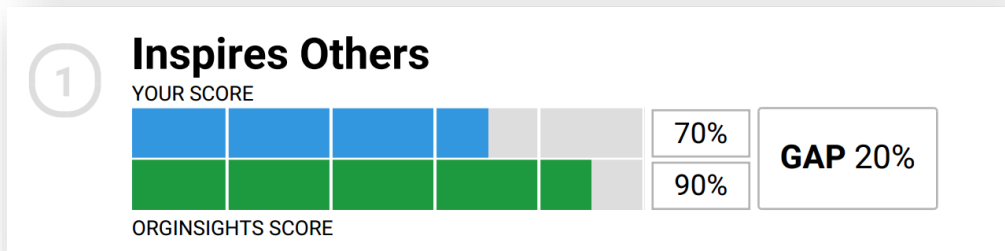
Example 4

It’s important to point out that the current level that you may operate, although efficient, may have some development required still to operate at higher levels. This many times happens when you are a strong subject area manager, but may not grasp the increase in overall scope and responsibilities that come with moving to a high-level role and how your area ties into a larger picture.

SCORING HIGHER THAN YOUR LEVEL

There are many times like **example 5**, that a person in a role will score higher in a capability than expected for their level. This is great! What this is indicative of, is that you are very strong in a capability. It is important to note though, that being flagged with a strong capability in the assessment, does not mean they have demonstrated this yet in their role.

The goal of this assessment is to flag key capabilities the you should focus on showcasing and/or developing. Knowing what capabilities to demonstrate is the first step, the second step requires the active use and demonstration of the capabilities to those they work with and in leadership level roles in the organization to ensure they can see your proficiency.

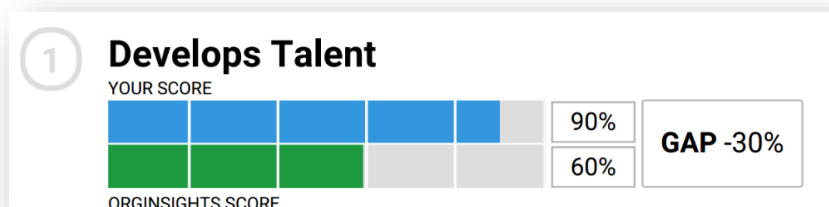


Example 5



## SCORING LOWER THAN EXPECTED IN PRESUMED STRENGTHS

There are occasions where you may score lower than they expected in certain areas you expect to be strengths. Another aspect you need to look at is how a question may be interpreted and answered by specific populations. In the below **example 6**, the Leader who took the assessment scored low in **Develops Talent**. As a Leader of a successful organization, they were of course shocked! To understand why you need to look at the questions that make up the OrgInsights and Self-Assessment score.



Example 6

### SELF ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

On a scale of 0 to 5 with 1 being 'Strongly Disagree' and 5 being 'Strongly Agree', how would you rate yourself on the following item.

|                                                                         |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| I actively seek personal development opportunities.                     | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| I consistently invest in the development of others (formal or informal) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

### ORGINSIGHTS QUESTIONS

| 0                                                         | 1                                                          | 2                                                               | 3                                                                   | 4                                                              | 5                                                             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Always prefer to read easy material.                      | Usually prefer to read easy material.                      | Occasionally prefer to read easy material.                      | Occasionally prefer to read challenging material.                   | Usually prefer to read challenging material.                   | Always prefer to read challenging material.                   |
| 0                                                         | 1                                                          | 2                                                               | 3                                                                   | 4                                                              | 5                                                             |
| Always prefer others to work to their existing strengths. | Usually prefer others to work to their existing strengths. | Occasionally prefer others to work to their existing strengths. | Occasionally prefer to challenge others to push themselves further. | Usually prefer to challenge others to push themselves further. | Always prefer to challenge others to push themselves further. |

In this example the reason they scored low in the **Develops Talent** section is the current organization they are in and the scenarios they are dealing with. In their role, they are constantly bombarded with decisions they need to make, Presentations to the Board, developing relationships with other industry leaders, transforming an organization and so much daily. For this reason, when they have time, they try to relax and stay away from challenging material. As well, in their organization, currently they are focusing on a transformation project that requires subject matter expertise. As a result, they would rather have people working to existing strengths.

In the above scenario, diving deeper into their scores allows you to understand why they answered the question. In the above scenario, by diving deeper, based on the Leader's current situation, the scores are reasonable but as well, it's important to remind them that a key aspect to their long-term growth is through developing talent.

# UNDERSTANDING THE CAPABILITIES THAT MATTER

**THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN EXPERIENCE AND CAPABILITIES**—As your client enters the workforce and starts their career (or is looking at moving up in their career), there are specific soft skills that will help them succeed and provide them a competitive advantage versus other candidates or employees. These are key capabilities that should be used in their resumes as well during interviews to give them a competitive edge.

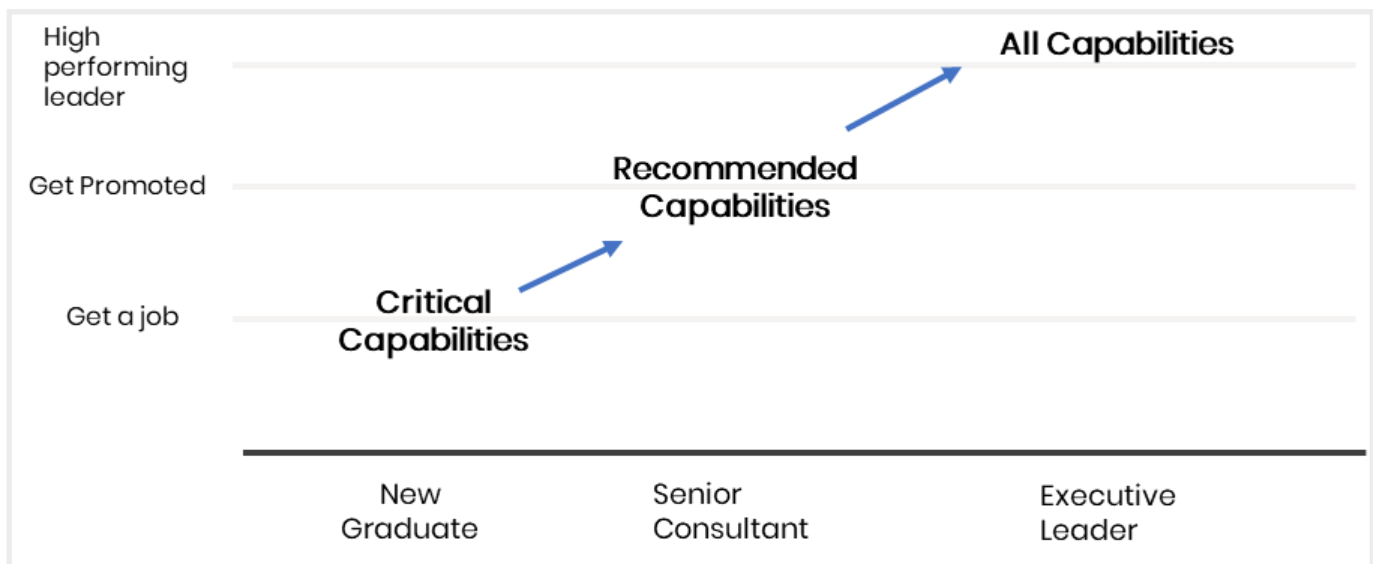
In this section, based on industry, we have flagged the capabilities that will help a person stand out as they are starting their career or transitioning into a different industry. A few things to note:

**Critical Capabilities:** Needed to secure a role in the industry and get your foot through the door.

**Recommended Capabilities:** capabilities recommended to help you be successful & grow in your role.

As a person gets more senior and gains experience, the expectation is, that they will need all capabilities developed to an acceptable level. At a Senior Executive level, there is an expectation, that they are strong in most if not all capabilities.

## VISUALIZATION OF RELATIONSHIP



# CAPABILITIES REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED BASED ON INDUSTRY

## Administrative and support services

|                        |                                        |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK            | Reasons Critically and solves problems |
| EMBRACES AGILITY       | Thrives in Chaos                       |
|                        | Empowers Team Effectiveness            |
| ACHEIVES EXCELLENCE    | Drives Performance and productivity    |
|                        | Evolves with Technology                |
| DEVELOPS RELATIONSHIPS | Focuses on customers                   |
| SETS PURPOSE           | Comminucates Clarity                   |

## Accounting and auditing

|                        |                                        |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK            | Reasons Critically and solves problems |
|                        | Establishes Governance                 |
| ACHEIVES EXCELLENCE    | Drives Performance and productivity    |
| DEVELOPS RELATIONSHIPS | Create Alliances                       |
|                        | Demonstrates Empathy                   |
| SETS PURPOSE           | Moves data action                      |

## Accommodation tourism and Hospitality Services

|                        |                                        |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK            | Reasons Critically and solves problems |
|                        | Thrives in Chaos                       |
| EMBRACES AGILITY       | Empowers team effectiveness            |
| DEVELOPS RELATIONSHIPS | Focuses on customers                   |
|                        | Embraces diversity                     |
| SETS PURPOSE           | Communicates clarity                   |

## Agriculture forestry fishing and hunting

|                        |                                        |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK            | Reasons Critically and solves problems |
| EMBRACES AGILITY       | Thrives in Chaos                       |
|                        | Evolves with Technology                |
| ACHEIVES EXCELLENCE    | takes ownership                        |
|                        | Drives performance and productivity    |
| DEVELOPS RELATIONSHIPS | Creates alliances                      |
| SETS PURPOSE           | Comminucates Clarity                   |

## Banking Finance and insurance

|                  |                                        |
|------------------|----------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK      | Reasons Critically and solves problems |
| EMBRACES AGILITY | Thrives in Chaos                       |
|                  | Empowers team effectiveness            |
|                  | Drives performance and productivity    |
|                  | Creates alliances                      |
| SETS PURPOSE     | Comminucates Clarity                   |
|                  | Moves data action                      |

## Construction Services

|              |                                        |
|--------------|----------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK  | Reasons Critically and solves problems |
|              | Empowers team effectiveness            |
|              | Thrives in Chaos                       |
|              | Drives performance and productivity    |
|              | Evolves with technology                |
| SETS PURPOSE | Comminucates Clarity                   |
|              | Moves data action                      |

## Cyber security

|                     |                                                                |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK         | Manage risk                                                    |
| EMBRACES AGILITY    | Reasons Critically and solves problems<br>Thrives in Chaos     |
| ACHEIVES EXCELLENCE | Drives performance and productivity<br>Evolves with technology |
| SETS PURPOSE        | Comminucates Clarity                                           |

## digital media entertaining and broadcasting

|                     |                                                                |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK         | Reasons Critically and solves problems<br>Thrives in Chaos     |
| EMBRACES AGILITY    | Empowers team effectiveness                                    |
| ACHEIVES EXCELLENCE | Drives performance and productivity<br>Evolves with technology |
| SETS PURPOSE        | Comminucates Clarity<br>Moves data action                      |

## Engineering and Technical consulting

|                        |                                                                                   |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK            | Reasons Critically and solves problems                                            |
| EMBRACES AGILITY       | Thrives in Chaos<br>Empowers team effectiveness                                   |
| ACHEIVES EXCELLENCE    | Evolves with Technology<br>takes ownership<br>Drives performance and productivity |
| DEVELOPS RELATIONSHIPS | Creates alliances                                                                 |
| SETS PURPOSE           | Comminucates Clarity<br>moves data to action                                      |

## Food and textile manufacturing

|                     |                                                                |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK         | Reasons critically and solve problems                          |
| EMBRACES AGILITY    | Empowers team effectiveness<br>Thrives in Chaos                |
| ACHEIVES EXCELLENCE | Drives performance and productivity<br>Evolves with technology |
| SETS PURPOSE        | Comminucates Clarity                                           |

## Healthcare and social assistance

|                        |                                                 |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK            | Reasons Critically and solves problems          |
| EMBRACES AGILITY       | Thrives in Chaos<br>Empowers team effectiveness |
| ACHEIVES EXCELLENCE    | Drives performance and productivity             |
| DEVELOPS RELATIONSHIPS | demonstrates empathy                            |
| SETS PURPOSE           | focuses on customer<br>Comminucates Clarity     |

## Information technology and cloud Technologies

|                     |                                                                |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK         | Reasons critically and solve problems                          |
| EMBRACES AGILITY    | Empowers team effectiveness<br>Thrives in Chaos                |
| ACHEIVES EXCELLENCE | Drives performance and productivity<br>Evolves with technology |
| SETS PURPOSE        | Comminucates Clarity                                           |

## mining wiring and oil and gas station

|                     |                                                                |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK         | Reasons critically and solve problems                          |
| EMBRACES AGILITY    | Empowers team effectiveness<br>Thrives in Chaos                |
| ACHEIVES EXCELLENCE | Drives performance and productivity<br>Evolves with technology |
| SETS PURPOSE        | Comminucates Clarity                                           |

## Professional and mgmt Consulting

|                        |                                                            |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK            | Reasons Critically and solves problems<br>Thrives in Chaos |
| EMBRACES AGILITY       | Empowers team effectiveness                                |
| ACHEIVES EXCELLENCE    | Drives performance and productivity                        |
| DEVELOPS RELATIONSHIPS | Influences responsibly<br>focuses on customer              |
| LIMITS RISK            | Comminucates Clarity<br>moves data to action               |

## Public administration (government/NGO Related Organizations)

|                  |                                                                                    |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK      | Scans for political and internal impacts<br>reasons critically and solves problems |
| EMBRACES AGILITY | Empowers team effectiveness<br>Thrives in Chaos                                    |
| LIMITS RISK      | Communicates Clarity<br>Embraces Diversity                                         |

## Real estate and rental and leasing

|                        |                                                                                    |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK            | Scans for political and internal impacts<br>reasons critically and solves problems |
| EMBRACES AGILITY       | Thrives in Chaos                                                                   |
| ACHIEVES EXCELLENCE    | Drives performance and productivity<br>Create Alliances                            |
| DEVELOPS RELATIONSHIPS | Influences Responsibly                                                             |
| LIMITS RISK            | Communicates Clarity                                                               |

## Retail Trade

|                        |                                                                |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| EMBRACES AGILITY       | Thrives in Chaos<br>Empowers team effectiveness                |
| ACHIEVES EXCELLENCE    | Drives performance and productivity<br>Evolves with Technology |
| DEVELOPS RELATIONSHIPS | focuses on customer<br>Influences responsibility               |
| LIMITS RISK            | Communicates Clarity<br>moves data to action                   |

## Start-up Organization – Tech and business Leadership

|                        |                                                        |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| EMBRACES AGILITY       | Thrives in Chaos<br>drive performance and productivity |
| ACHIEVES EXCELLENCE    | Evolves with technology<br>Takes Ownership             |
| DEVELOPS RELATIONSHIPS | Create Alliances                                       |
| SETS PURPOSE           | Communicates Clarity<br>moves data to action           |

## Supply chain transportation and warehousing

|                     |                                                                |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK         | Reasons critically and solve problems                          |
| EMBRACES AGILITY    | Empowers team effectiveness<br>Thrives in Chaos                |
| ACHIEVES EXCELLENCE | Drives performance and productivity<br>Evolves with technology |
| SETS PURPOSE        | Communicates Clarity<br>Moves data action                      |

## Utilities and energy production

|                     |                                                                  |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| LIMITS RISK         | Reasons Critically and solves problems<br>establishes governance |
| EMBRACES AGILITY    | Empowers team effectiveness<br>Thrives in Chaos                  |
| ACHIEVES EXCELLENCE | Drives performance and productivity<br>Evolves with technology   |
| SETS PURPOSE        | takes ownership<br>Communicates Clarity                          |